

A Comparative Overview of the Modern, Late Modern, and Post-Modern in Architecture

(Following Charles Jencks)

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Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
One international style or 'no style'	Unconscious style	Double-coding of style
Utopian & idealist	Pragmatic	Popular & pluralist
Deterministic form, functional	Loose fit	Semiotic form
Artist as a prophet & healer	Suppressed artist	Artist /client
Elitist/for everyone	Elitist professional	Elitist & participative
Holistic, comprehensive redevelopment	Holistic	Piecemeal
Architect as a savior/doctor	Architect provides service	Architect as representative and activist

Ideological



Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
City in park	Monuments in park	Contextual urbanism and rehabilitation
Functional separation	Functions within a shed	Functional mixing
Skin and bones	Slick skin with optical effect	Mannerist and baroque
Volume and mass	Enclosed skin volumes	Skew spaces and extensions
Slab, point block	Extruded building, linearity	Street building

Design Ideas



Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
Transparency	Literal transparency	Ambiguity
Asymmetry and regularity	Tends to symmetry, formal rotation, mirroring, series	Tends to asymmetrical symmetry
Harmonious integration	Packaged harmony, forced harmony	Collage, collision

Design Ideas



Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
Straight-forwardness	Slick-Tech/High-Tech	Hybrid Expression
Simplicity	Complex Simplicity, ambiguous reference	Complexity
Isotropic space (Chicago frame, Domino)	Extreme Isotropic space (open office planning, redundancy and flatness)	Variable space with surprises
Abstract form	Sculptural form, enigmatic form	Conventional and abstract form
Purist	Extreme repetition and purist	Eclectic (selecting ideas from various sources)
Inarticulate 'dumb box'	Extreme articulation	Semiotic signs & symbols, articulation

Stylistic



Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
Machine aesthetics, mechanical, technology & structure	2 nd machine aesthetics, Extreme logic, circulation, mechanical, technical & structure	Variable mixed aesthetics depending on context, expression of content and semantic appropriateness towards function
Anti-ornament	Structure and construction as ornament	Pro-organic and applied ornament
Anti representational	Represent logic, circulation, mechanical technology and structure, frozen movement	Pro-representation

Stylistic



Modern	Late-modern	Post -Modern
Anti-metaphor	Anti-metaphor	Pro-metaphor
Anti-historical memory	Anti-historical	Pro-historical reference
Anti-humour	Unintended humour	Pro-humour
Anti-symbolic	Unintended symbolic	Pro-symbolic